DoorDash Dasher

Complete Account Opening Guide

Food & Grocery Delivery Service

Welcome to your comprehensive DoorDash Dasher guide! DoorDash is the largest food delivery platform in the United States, operating in over 7,000 cities. As a Dasher, you'll have the flexibility to earn money on your own schedule by delivering food from local restaurants and groceries from stores to hungry customers. This detailed guide ensures you complete the sign-up process correctly for fast approval.

Requirements Before You Start

- Must be at least 18 years old
- Valid driver's license (required for car delivery; not needed for bike/walk)
- Smartphone running iOS 14+ or Android 8+
- Reliable transportation (car, bike, scooter, or walk in select cities)
- Auto insurance (if delivering by car)
- Social Security Number for tax purposes
- Bank account or debit card for receiving payments
- Clean background check
- Ability to lift up to 30 lbs

Step 1: Download the DoorDash Dasher App

- Open the App Store (iPhone) or Google Play Store (Android)
- Search for "DoorDash Dasher" - this is different from the customer DoorDash app!
- Look for the app with the RED Dasher icon (not the regular DoorDash customer app)
- The correct app will say "Dasher" and is specifically for delivery drivers
- Download and install the official Dasher app
- Open the app once installation is complete

■ TIP: The Dasher app has a red background with white text - don't confuse it with the customer app!

Step 2: Start Your Dasher Application

- Tap "Get Started" or "Sign Up" on the welcome screen
- Enter your email address - use an email you check frequently
- Enter your mobile phone number and verify with the SMS code
- Create a secure password for your account
- IMPORTANT: When asked for your location or ZIP code, enter one of the codes from GIG ZipFinder
- Select your delivery method: Car, Bike, Scooter, or Walk (car offers the most opportunities)
- Confirm you meet the minimum age requirement of 18 years

■ TIP: Using an open zip code dramatically increases your chances of being accepted!

Step 3: Provide Personal Information

- Enter your full legal name as it appears on your government ID
- Provide your date of birth (must be 18 or older)
- Enter your Social Security Number for background check and tax documents (1099)
- Input your complete current address including city, state, and ZIP code

- This information is used for identity verification and required tax reporting
- Review all entries carefully before proceeding

■ TIP: Your personal information is protected by DoorDash's secure encryption systems.

Step 4: Upload Required Documents

- Take a clear photo of your driver's license (front side)
- If using a car, you may need to provide vehicle registration and insurance
- Take a selfie for identity verification - ensure good lighting and face the camera directly
- All photos must be clear, in focus, and show all required information
- Avoid shadows, glare, or blurry images
- Your license must be valid and not expired

■ TIP: Use a flat, well-lit surface when photographing documents to avoid shadows.

Step 5: Accept Terms & Complete Background Check

- Read and carefully review the Independent Contractor Agreement
- Accept the DoorDash Dasher Terms of Service
- Consent to the background check conducted by Checkr
- The background check reviews your driving history and criminal background
- Background checks typically take 5-7 business days to complete
- You'll receive email updates on your application status
- Some applicants may be approved within 24-48 hours

■ TIP: Keep notifications enabled to receive real-time updates on your application.

Step 6: Set Up Payment & Start Dashing

- Choose your preferred payment method after approval
- Option 1: Direct deposit to your bank account (payments every Monday)
- Option 2: DasherDirect card - get a free debit card with instant access to earnings daily
- Enter your bank account information or sign up for DasherDirect

- Complete the quick in-app orientation video
- Set your availability schedule in the app
- You're ready to start accepting delivery orders!

■ TIP: DasherDirect offers instant cashout with no fees - highly recommended!

Pro Tips for DoorDash Success

✓ Dash during lunch (11 AM - 2 PM) and dinner (5 PM - 9 PM) for maximum orders

✓ Accept orders from restaurants you know for faster pickups

✓ Use a hot bag to keep food warm - customers appreciate it

✓ Decline low-paying orders that don't meet your earnings goals

✓ Park legally to avoid tickets that cut into your profits

✓ Track your mileage for tax deductions at the end of the year

✓ Build a good rating by communicating with customers and being on time

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Generated: February 10, 2026